

Assessment Book — French Revolution

History | Grade 9-10

Questions

Total marks

98

Q1. (6 marks) Recall the commonly given start and end dates of the French Revolution as presented in the document, and quote the document's exact phrasing that defines its beginning and end. (6 marks)

Q2. (3 marks) Explain how social, economic and political factors combined to produce a crisis that led Louis XVI to call the Estates-General in 1789. In your answer, give brief evidence for each type of factor and link them to the decision to summon the Estates-General. (3 marks)

Q3. (1 mark) Which explanation best links the causes and immediate consequences of the Reign of Terror (Sept 1793–July 1794) to the rise of the Thermidorian Reaction and the end of the Terror?

- A. A drive to eliminate counter-revolutionary threat led the Committee of Public Safety to expand arrests and executions, creating fear and political polarisation that caused moderates in the Convention to unite and remove Robespierre, ending the Terror and prompting the Thermidorian Reaction.
- B. Economic crisis and food shortages were the main cause of the Terror, and when grain supplies improved in July 1794 ordinary people turned against the Jacobins so the Convention closed the Jacobin Club and stopped executions.
- C. The Terror's broad use of laws like the Law of 22 Prairial to speed trials increased executions and targeted both royalists and rival revolutionaries; that legalised brutality alarmed many deputies, who denounced and arrested Robespierre in July 1794, ended the Terror, and set the stage for Thermidorian moderation.
- D. Foreign military victories removed the need for internal repression, so the Convention voluntarily repealed harsh laws, executed Robespierre for unrelated crimes, and moved immediately to establish the Directory to stabilise the government.

Q4. (6 marks) Using evidence from the chapter, describe two different ways that newspapers or revolutionary symbols (for example *La Marseillaise*, the cockade, the tricolore, or the liberty cap) influenced public perception during the French Revolution. In each case, say what the medium or symbol did and give one piece of supporting evidence from the chapter. (6 marks)

Q5. (3 marks) Explain the significance of the Storming of the Bastille on 14 July 1789 for the French Revolution. In your answer, give two specific effects it had on the National Assembly or revolutionary actions. (3 marks)

Q6. (1 mark) Which of the following best describes the main effects of the August Decrees issued by the National Assembly during the French Revolution?

- A. They abolished feudal privileges, ended seigneurial dues and church tithes, and established equality before the law for citizens

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- B. They removed the king from power, replacing the monarchy with an elected executive and immediate universal suffrage
- C. They strengthened the Catholic Church's role, restoring tithes and giving clergy new legal privileges
- D. They secured property rights for the nobility and increased their political power while keeping peasant obligations

Q7. (6 marks) Explain why the National Assembly confiscated church property and passed the Civil Constitution of the Clergy (12 July 1790). In your answer, describe the measures taken and the key political and social effects these actions had on the Revolution. (6 marks)

Q8. (3 marks) Identify two key features of the Constitutional Monarchy period (July 1789 – 3 September 1792). Then briefly explain how the rule of 'active citizens' limited political participation during this period.

Q9. (1 mark) How did King Louis XVI's attempted Flight to Varennes in June 1791 affect public trust in the French monarchy and the actions of revolutionary leaders?

- A. It led many people to support immediate abolition of the monarchy and the execution of the king without further debate
- B. It discredited the king, increased suspicion of royal intentions, and pushed revolutionaries to demand oaths of loyalty and to prepare for confrontation and war
- C. It strengthened the king's authority because his escape attempt showed he could act decisively to preserve the monarchy
- D. It directly caused foreign armies to invade France the following month because other monarchs used the flight as a *casus belli*

Q10. (6 marks) Explain how military defeats and growing insurrection led to the events of 10 August 1792 and the fall of the monarchy, and how these events contributed to the proclamation of the French First Republic in September 1792. In your answer, include key actions on 10 August and at least one different interpretation of why the monarchy collapsed. (6 marks)

Q11. (3 marks) On 22 September 1792 the National Convention made two linked decisions that reshaped France. Briefly state each decision and explain why making 1792 'Year One' was significant for revolutionary France. (3 marks)

Q12. (1 mark) Which sequence correctly states the date Louis XVI was sentenced to death and the date he was executed during the French Revolution?

- A. Sentenced to death on 21 January 1793 and executed on 17 January 1793
- B. Sentenced to death on 21 January 1793 and executed later that year in July 1793
- C. Sentenced to death on 17 January 1793 and executed on 21 January 1793
- D. Sentenced to death in December 1792 and executed on 21 January 1793

Q13. (6 marks) Explain the role and significance of the Committee of Public Safety between April 1793 and the Reign of Terror. In your answer, describe how the Committee came to dominate the Convention, two main powers or actions it exercised, and one reason why historians argue it became associated with the Terror. (6 marks)

Q14. (3 marks) Explain how the coup of 18 Brumaire (1799) ended the Directory and created the

Consulate with Napoleon Bonaparte as First Consul. In your answer, describe the key actions or events that brought about this change.

Q15. (1 mark) What was a key effect of the Law of 22 Prairial (10 June) during the French Revolution?

- A. It denied accused 'enemies of the people' the right to a defense and led to a sharp rise in executions in Paris.
- B. It guaranteed fairer trials for suspects and caused a noticeable fall in executions by the Revolutionary Tribunal.
- C. It restricted the Revolutionary Tribunal to economic crimes involving property and finances only.
- D. It required judges to gather detailed evidence and witness testimony before any conviction could occur.

Q16. (6 marks) Explain the main political consequences of the Thermidorian Reaction (after Robespierre's fall) for revolutionary France. In your answer, describe what happened to those associated with the Terror, how the government responded to insurrections, and why some former Terror actors remained in positions of power. (6 marks)

Q17. (3 marks) Explain two key institutional features created by the Constitution of the Year III (1795) and briefly describe how deputies and the five directors were chosen under this system.

Q18. (6 marks) Explain the main political and economic challenges faced by the Directory between 1795 and 1799, and how these problems led it to rely on military force until the coup of 18 Brumaire. (6 marks)

Q19. (3 marks) Explain how the French Revolution led to large-scale national mobilisation and name two territories France had gained or annexed by 1795. In your answer, give one specific example of mobilisation and two territorial gains with dates.

Q20. (6 marks) Explain the significance of the French Convention's vote on 4 February 1794 to abolish slavery in the colonies, and how the earlier actions of commissioners in Saint-Domingue related to that decision. In your answer, refer to the legal changes, the motives or pressures behind the vote, and at least one consequence for the colonies. (6 marks)

Q21. (6 marks) Explain how and why the guillotine came to be the principal symbol of the Terror during the French Revolution. In your answer, describe its origins and practical purpose, how it functioned as public spectacle and cultural symbol, and mention at least one competing interpretation of its meaning.

Q22. (6 marks) Explain how the role of women in the French Revolution changed between its early years and 1793. In your answer describe both the forms of female political activity and the ways in which women were later repressed or excluded from politics. Support your explanation with specific examples and brief reference to differing interpretations of why this change occurred. (6 marks)

Q23. (6 marks) Explain how the issuance of assignats, government price controls, and economic conditions combined to produce inflation and market distortion in revolutionary France, and why the assignats were withdrawn in 1796. In your answer refer to the nationalisation of Church and émigré lands, the causes of inflation, and the effects of price controls.

Q24. (6 marks) Explain the long-term impact of the French Revolution on France and on Europe. In your answer, give at least three distinct effects and show one example of how historians disagree about the importance of one of those effects. (6 marks)

Answer Key — teacher copy, not for distribution to students

Answer Key

Q1.

Answer: The document gives the start date as 1789 and the end date as 9 November 1799. The exact phrasing in the document is: "The French Revolution was a period of political and societal change in France that began with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799."

Rubric — Accuracy of recalled start and end dates and citation of the document's exact phrasing.

Full credit (6 marks): Gives the correct start year (1789) and correct end date (9 November 1799) and reproduces the document's exact phrasing verbatim: "The French Revolution was a period of political and societal change in France that began with the Estates General of 1789 and ended with the Coup of 18 Brumaire on 9 November 1799."

Partial credit (3 marks): Gives both correct dates (1789 and 9 November 1799) but does not reproduce the document wording exactly — answer paraphrases the definition or omits small parts of the quoted phrase.

No credit (0 marks): Incorrect or missing start and/or end dates, or no citation of the document phrasing.

Q2.

Answer: Socially, France was deeply divided: the privileged First and Second Estates enjoyed legal exemptions while the Third Estate (peasants, urban workers and bourgeoisie) bore heavy taxes and resented inequalities — this widespread popular discontent created pressure for change. Economically, repeated poor harvests, rising bread prices and a heavy national debt (exacerbated by war spending) produced hardship and a fiscal crisis; the government could not raise enough revenue without reform. Politically, the ruling elite resisted meaningful reform and the king's ministers were indecisive, so attempts to solve the fiscal emergency failed. Together these factors produced a fiscal and political deadlock: unable to implement reforms alone and facing unrest, Louis XVI called the Estates-General in May 1789 to seek consent for taxation and break the impasse. The Third Estate's later breakaway into a National Assembly in June shows how the social grievances and political stalemate escalated after the Estates-General convened.

Rubric — Explanation of how social, economic and political factors combined to create a crisis leading to the calling of the Estates-General, with brief evidence and a clear link to the decision.

3 marks (3 marks): Identifies and explains all three types of factors (social, economic, political), gives specific evidence for each (e.g. privileges of estates, poor harvests/debt, elite resistance/indecision), and clearly links how these combined to force Louis XVI to call the Estates-General (shows fiscal/political deadlock and popular pressure).

2 marks (2 marks): Explains two of the three factors with appropriate evidence and gives a plausible link to the calling of the Estates-General, or mentions all three factors but with limited detail or weak linkage to the decision.

1 mark (1 marks): Identifies one relevant factor (social, economic or political) with brief or vague evidence, or gives a very general statement that the situation caused a crisis without explaining how.

Q3.

Correct: C. The Terror's broad use of laws like the Law of 22 Prairial to speed trials increased executions and targeted both royalists and rival revolutionaries; that legalised brutality alarmed many deputies, who denounced and arrested Robespierre in July 1794, ended the Terror, and set the stage for Thermidorian moderation.

A. Partly correct about arrests and polarisation, but it simplifies the mechanism: it omits the role of specific legal measures (e.g., the Law of 22 Prairial) that sped prosecutions and alarmed deputies, and it presents the moderates' actions as simply 'uniting' rather than reacting to perceived danger from Jacobin policy.

B. Incorrect cause-effect: while economic hardship affected politics, the prompt data emphasises political-legal measures and mass arrests/executions as central to the Terror. Improved grain alone did not trigger the Thermidorian Reaction as described in the source.

C. Correct: this ties the Terror's legal mechanisms (Law of 22 Prairial), mass executions, and the resulting alarm among Convention deputies to the denunciation, arrest and execution of Robespierre in July 1794, which ended the Terror and led to Thermidorian moderation.

D. Misstates sequence and causes: foreign victories were not the proximate reason given for ending the Terror, and the Directory was not established immediately after Robespierre's fall (the Committee was later replaced by the Directory in November 1795). It also implies Robespierre's execution was unrelated to the Terror's policies, which conflicts with the historical record.

Q4.

Answer: 1) Newspapers and pamphlets spread revolutionary ideas and shaped popular opinion by reporting events, arguing political positions, and encouraging participation. Evidence: the chapter notes that over 130 newspapers appeared in 1789 and more than 2,000 were founded in the following decade; these publications debated issues, publicised grievances, and mobilised support for actions such as petitions and protests. By increasing the flow of information and opinion, newspapers turned private complaints into public causes and made political debate part of everyday life.

2) Revolutionary symbols — for example the cockade, the tricolore and La Marseillaise — created shared identity and emotional commitment to the Revolution, signalling who belonged to the new political community. Evidence: the chapter describes the blue-and-red cockade of Paris and the Phrygian liberty cap as widely used emblems linking the movement to republican and classical traditions, and records that La Marseillaise was composed in 1792 and adopted by the National Convention as the anthem in 1795. These symbols simplified complex ideas into visible signs and songs that could be recognised, worn or sung in public, strengthening solidarity and marking people as supporters of revolutionary change.

Rubric — Use of specific evidence plus clear explanation of two distinct influences on public perception.

Full marks (6 marks): Two distinct ways are clearly described (one about newspapers/pamphlets and one about symbols OR two different effects), each explanation explains how public perception was influenced, and each is supported by a specific piece of evidence from the chapter (e.g. numbers of newspapers, date/composer/adoption of La Marseillaise, description of cockade/liberty cap).

Partial credit (3 marks): One way is fully explained with chapter evidence and a second way is attempted but lacks either a clear influence on public perception or specific supporting evidence from the chapter.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Only one brief or vague point is made about influence with little or no chapter evidence, or two points are given but both lack explanation of how they changed public perception.

Q5.

Answer: The Storming of the Bastille (14 July 1789) was important because it became a powerful symbol of popular opposition to royal authority and forced the revolutionary government to respond. Two specific effects were: (1) it helped to legitimise and strengthen Parisian revolutionary forces — for example, the formation and recognition of the Parisian National Guard and the elevation of popular leaders, which shifted power toward popular revolutionary organisations; (2) it accelerated political change by pressuring the National Assembly to adopt radical measures shortly afterwards, such as the August Decrees that began to abolish feudal privileges and the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen, showing the Assembly responding to popular demands. Together these effects show how the Bastille triggered both immediate popular mobilisation and a series of radical acts by the Assembly.

Rubric — How well the response explains significance and gives two linked, specific effects on the Assembly or revolutionary actions.

Full credit (3 marks): Clearly explains the significance and gives two specific, accurate effects linked to Assembly actions or revolutionary change (e.g., recognition/strengthening of revolutionary forces such as the National Guard; pressure leading to the August Decrees and the Declaration of the Rights of Man).

Partial credit (2 marks): Gives one clear specific effect with explanation, or lists two accurate effects but with minimal explanation or link to the Assembly's measures.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Identifies one correct, relevant effect or states that the Bastille forced the Assembly to take radical measures but without specific examples or clear explanation.

Q6.

Correct: A. They abolished feudal privileges, ended seigneurial dues and church tithes, and established equality before the law for citizens

A. Correct — the August Decrees were a series of laws passed to abolish feudal rights and dues, cancel church tithes, and affirm legal equality; they targeted old privileges rather than creating a new government form.

B. Wrong — this confuses the Decrees with later political changes; the August Decrees reformed social and legal privileges but did not remove the king or instantly create universal suffrage.

C. Wrong — this is the opposite of what the Decrees did; they curtailed the church's economic privileges by abolishing tithes rather than strengthening them.

D. Wrong — this misunderstands the Decrees: they dismantled many noble privileges and peasant obligations instead of securing or expanding noble property rights and power.

Q7.

Answer: The Assembly confiscated church property to solve the fiscal crisis: nationalising church lands provided assets that could be used to back new paper money (assignats) and to pay state debts. On 12 July 1790 the Civil Constitution of the Clergy made the Catholic clergy employees of the state, reorganised dioceses to match new départements, required election of priests and bishops, and compelled clergy to swear an oath of loyalty to the constitution. Politically and socially, these measures stabilised government finance in the short term by creating assignats backed by national lands, but they deeply divided the church and French society. The required oath split priests into 'jurors' (those who swore) and 'non-jurors' or refractory clergy (those who refused), alienating many devout peasants and provoking resistance in the countryside. This religious rupture fuelled counter-revolutionary activity, weakened moderate support for the Revolution, and intensified polarisation between revolutionaries and traditionalists. Historians debate the interpretation: some argue the reforms were necessary to secularise and rationalise

France and to secure finance; others see them as politically reckless, needlessly antagonising popular religion and helping to produce internal conflict.

Rubric — Explanations of reasons, description of measures, and analysis of political/social effects grounded in evidence and interpretations

Comprehensive (6 marks) (6 marks): Clearly explains why church property was confiscated and outlines the main provisions of the Civil Constitution (including date 12 July 1790, clergy as state employees, reorganisation of dioceses, elections, and the oath). Describes key effects (assignats/backing of paper money, division into jurors and non-jurors, peasant alienation, counter-revolutionary consequences, political polarisation) and refers to at least one competing interpretation or contextual point. Evidence and causation are explicit.

Partial (3 marks) (3 marks): Identifies either the confiscation of church lands to back assignats OR the Civil Constitution and its basic effect (state control of clergy and requirement of an oath), and gives one or two consequences (e.g., division among clergy or financing the state) but explanation lacks detail, key evidence (date, specific measures) or discussion of wider political and social effects.

Insufficient (0 marks) (0 marks): Provides incorrect information, only vague statements, or fails to explain reasons, measures, or consequences in any meaningful way.

Q8.

Answer: Two key features were: (1) establishment of a written constitution and creation of a constitutional monarchy that limited the king's powers and set out new institutions (e.g., a legislative assembly); (2) restriction of political rights through the distinction between 'active' and 'passive' citizens, creating limited, property-based male suffrage and indirect election procedures. The rule of 'active citizens' limited participation by allowing only adult men who met property or tax qualifications (and sometimes age or residency requirements) to vote and hold office, excluding women, the poor, and many urban workers from political rights.

Rubric — Correct identification of two key features and clear explanation of how 'active citizens' limited political participation.

Full marks (3 marks): Names two distinct, accurate features of the period (one must refer to the constitution/constitutional monarchy and one to restricted political rights or institutions) AND clearly explains that 'active citizens' were limited by property/tax (and related) qualifications which excluded women, the poor, and many workers from voting/holding office.

Partial credit (2 marks): Either (a) names two relevant features but gives only a weak or incomplete explanation of 'active citizens' (e.g., simply says 'some people could not vote' without specifying property/tax/sex exclusions), OR (b) names only one feature correctly but gives a correct explanation of the 'active citizens' restriction.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Provides one partly correct feature or a very general statement about limited rights (e.g., 'voting was limited') without identifying constitution/monarchy or the property/tax basis of 'active citizens'.

No credit (0 marks): Responses that are incorrect, irrelevant, or blank (no correct feature and no correct explanation of 'active citizens').

Q9.

Correct: B. It discredited the king, increased suspicion of royal intentions, and pushed revolutionaries to demand oaths of loyalty and to prepare for confrontation and war

A. Overstates the immediate outcome: while the flight increased hostility, it did not produce unanimous support for immediate abolition and execution without further political struggle; radicals gained ground but debates and legal processes continued.

B. Correct — the king's attempted escape revealed his willingness to flee and negotiate with foreign powers, undermining trust, increasing suspicion among patriots, and prompting demands for oaths, tighter controls,

and preparations that moved France closer to conflict.

C. Contradicts the historical evidence: the flight weakened rather than strengthened Louis's credibility; it undermined royal authority by making him appear disloyal to the nation.

D. Misstates timing and causation: foreign monarchs became hostile later, but there was not an immediate invasion the next month solely because of the flight; diplomatic tensions rose and contributed to war later, but not an instant invasion.

Q10.

Answer: By summer 1792 a series of military setbacks (notably defeats at Verdun and the Brunswick Manifesto which threatened Paris) increased fear that the revolutionary government and the nation were endangered. These defeats undermined confidence in King Louis XVI, who was suspected of royalist sympathy and collusion with foreign powers. At the same time Paris saw growing popular insurrection: armed fédérés and sans-culottes, radical deputies (like the Commune of Paris) and revolutionary newspapers pushed for direct action. On 10 August 1792 insurgents and National Guard elements attacked the Tuileries Palace, where the king sheltered with his Swiss Guards. The fighting led to the massacre or disarmament of the Swiss Guards, the suspension and arrest of the king, and the effective end of royal authority. The Legislative Assembly then called elections for a National Convention which abolished the monarchy and, in September 1792, proclaimed the French First Republic. Historians disagree about causes: one interpretation emphasizes structural pressures — military defeats and foreign threats making the king politically untenable — while another stresses social and political radicalisation in Paris (economic hardship, popular politics, and republican agitation) as the decisive force. Both factors together best explain why the monarchy fell on 10 August and why republicans moved quickly to found the Republic in September.

Rubric — Explanation of causal link between military defeats, insurrection (10 August), and the fall of the monarchy leading to the Republic

Comprehensive (6 marks) (6 marks): Provides a clear, well-structured explanation linking military defeats (e.g. Verdun, Brunswick Manifesto) and rising popular insurrection to the attack on the Tuileries on 10 August; describes key actions on 10 August (assault on Tuileries, Swiss Guards neutralised, arrest/suspension of the king); explains how these events led to elections/National Convention and the proclamation of the Republic in September; includes at least one alternative interpretation (e.g. structural military pressure vs. urban radicalisation) and shows how they interact, with specific evidence.

Partial (3 marks) (3 marks): Explains that military defeats and popular unrest contributed to the 10 August attack and the king's downfall and notes that the Republic followed, but gives limited or general detail about the events of 10 August (may omit Swiss Guards, arrests, or the link to the National Convention) or presents only one cause without acknowledging alternative interpretations.

Minimal/Incorrect (0 marks) (0 marks): Gives an incomplete, vague, or incorrect account that fails to link military defeats and insurrection to the events of 10 August and the fall of the monarchy, or merely restates facts without explanation; does not mention the consequences leading to the Republic or supply an alternative interpretation.

Q11.

Answer: On 22 September 1792 the Convention abolished the monarchy and proclaimed the French First Republic. It also introduced a new Revolutionary calendar, declaring 1792 to be 'Year One'. Declaring 1792 as Year One was significant because it marked a deliberate break with the ancien régime and the old royalist chronology, symbolising a new political order and

the start of a revolutionary era aimed at founding a secular, republican society.

Rubric — Identifying the two actions taken and explaining the symbolic significance of declaring 1792 'Year One'.

Full response (3 marks): Clearly states both actions (abolition of the monarchy/proclamation of the First Republic AND introduction of a new calendar with 1792 as Year One) and gives a clear explanation that declaring Year One symbolised a deliberate break with the past/*ancien régime* and the start of a new revolutionary political order.

Partial response (2 marks): States both actions but gives only a minimal or vague explanation of the significance (for example, says it was a 'new start' without linking this to breaking with the *ancien régime* or founding a new political order), or states one action and provides a clear explanation of the significance.

Limited response (1 marks): States only one of the actions OR mentions both actions without any explanation of why declaring Year One mattered (e.g. rote listing with no context).

Q12.

Correct: C. Sentenced to death on 17 January 1793 and executed on 21 January 1793

A. Reverses the two dates; it confuses the sentencing and execution dates, implying the execution happened before the sentence.

B. Mixes up the known immediate timing; there is no historical evidence that execution occurred months later in July 1793 after a January sentencing.

C. Correct — historical records show Louis XVI was sentenced to death on 17 January 1793 and was executed a few days later on 21 January 1793.

D. Places the sentencing earlier in December 1792, which misreads the timeline; the formal sentence was given on 17 January 1793, not in December.

Q13.

Answer: The Committee of Public Safety, created on 6 April 1793, became the Convention's central executive body during a period of internal crisis and external war. It came to dominate the Convention because the Convention delegated emergency powers to it to coordinate war effort and internal security, and because leading revolutionaries (for example, Robespierre and Saint-Just) used their influence within the Committee to push policy. Two main powers or actions it exercised were: (1) directing the military and organizing *levées en masse* and centralised war administration to defend France against foreign armies; and (2) supervising the policing and judicial machinery at home, for example by creating representatives on mission and supporting the Revolutionary Tribunal to arrest, try and execute suspected counter-revolutionaries. Historians link the Committee to the Reign of Terror because its emergency powers and authority over policing and tribunals made repression systematic: its belief that revolutionary survival justified harsh measures, combined with urgent wartime pressures and weak legal safeguards, led to widespread use of summary trials and executions. Some historians emphasise intentional policy from Committee leaders; others argue the Terror resulted more from situation and institutional incentives (war, economic crisis, and delegated powers) than a single conspiratorial plan.

Rubric — Explanation of how the Committee dominated the Convention, two powers/actions it exercised, and a justified reason linking it to the Terror.

Full marks (6 marks): Clearly explains how the Committee came to dominate the Convention (delegation of emergency powers and influence of leading members), gives two accurate powers/actions (e.g. directing the war effort/*levée en masse* and supervising policing/Tribunals/representatives on mission), and gives a reasoned link to the Terror that cites how emergency powers and control of tribunals/policing led to systematic repression;

may note competing historical interpretations.

Partial credit (3 marks): Explains part of how the Committee became dominant or names only one clear mechanism of dominance, gives one clear power/action and a second partial or vague action, and provides a plausible but underdeveloped link to the Terror (for example, asserts repression without explaining the institutional or wartime causes).

Minimal / incorrect (0 marks): Provides minimal, vague, or inaccurate statements (e.g. only says the Committee existed or lists unrelated facts), fails to identify two actions/powers, and does not explain why the Committee is associated with the Terror.

Q14.

Answer: Political leaders (notably Sieyès) colluded with Napoleon; on 18 Brumaire troops led by Napoleon forced the resignation or exile of the Directors and dispersed or intimidated the legislative councils. A new constitution was then drawn up establishing the Consulate, concentrating executive power in three consuls with Napoleon installed as First Consul, thereby ending the Directory and placing real authority in Napoleon's hands.

Rubric — Explanation of how the coup overthrew the Directory and led to the Consulate with Napoleon as First Consul.

Full marks (3 marks): Clearly states that Sieyès and Napoleon conspired; describes the use of troops on 18 Brumaire to remove or force the Directors from power and to intimidate or disperse the legislative councils; explains that a new constitution created the Consulate and that Napoleon became First Consul concentrating executive power.

Partial credit (2 marks): Identifies either the overthrow of the Directory by force or the establishment of the Consulate with Napoleon as First Consul, but omits one of the key elements (e.g. role of troops, role of Sieyès/plots, or the constitutional change creating the Consulate).

Minimal or incorrect (0 marks): Gives a vague, incorrect, or very incomplete account (e.g. mentions Napoleon became leader without explaining the coup or how the Directory ended).

Q15.

Correct: A. It denied accused 'enemies of the people' the right to a defense and led to a sharp rise in executions in Paris.

A. Correct — the Law of 22 Prairial removed many legal protections for those labeled 'enemies of the people', limited defense rights, and is historically linked to a dramatic increase in executions in Paris.

B. Incorrect — this reverses the historical effect. The law reduced legal protections rather than guaranteeing fairer trials and did not lower execution rates.

C. Incorrect — the law did not narrow the Tribunal's focus to property crimes; instead it broadened the Tribunal's power over political suspects and simplified convictions.

D. Incorrect — the law did the opposite of requiring more evidence: it simplified procedures, often eliminating the need for detailed evidence or witness testimony before conviction.

Q16.

Answer: After Thermidor (July 1794) the Convention moved to roll back the Terror but produced a complex mixture of repression and continuity. In the immediate aftermath there were revenge killings and popular violence in parts of southern France and some districts of Paris, and leading Paris Commune figures and prominent Jacobins were arrested and executed or imprisoned as the Convention purged the most radical elements. At the same time the Thermidorians did not entirely exclude former Terror actors: some who had technical or administrative expertise, or

who shifted politically to accommodate the new majority, kept offices because the government still needed experienced administrators and army officers. The Convention also relied on military force and diplomatic moves to end active insurrections: military victories and treaties in 1795 reduced external threats and allowed troops and negotiators to be used to suppress uprisings (for example governments negotiated peace and used victorious armies to stabilise rebellious provinces). Historians debate emphasis: one view stresses a deliberate policy of political revenge and liberal reaction, another highlights pragmatic continuity (retention of personnel and use of the army) that aimed to restore order while avoiding a complete rupture with the revolutionary state.

Rubric — Explanation of political consequences of Thermidorian Reaction, covering reprisals, suppression of insurrections, and reasons some former Terror actors stayed in power.

Comprehensive (6 marks) (6 marks): Explains all three required elements: details of reprisals (southern violence and executions of Commune leaders), how the government suppressed insurrections (use of troops and diplomatic/treaty moves), and clear reasons why some former Terror actors retained positions (administrative/military expertise, political accommodation). Provides contextual evidence and notes competing interpretations about revenge versus pragmatic continuity.

Partial (3 marks) (3 marks): Addresses two of the three elements clearly or all three in limited detail. For example, describes reprisals and suppression of insurrections but gives only a brief or vague reason for retention of some Terror figures, or explains reasons and reprisals but only mentions suppression without linking to treaties or military success.

Insufficient (0 marks) (0 marks): Fails to explain the political consequences accurately: missing or incorrect description of reprisals, suppression of insurrections, and reasons for retention of former Terror actors; answer is largely irrelevant or factual errors.

Q17.

Answer: The Constitution of the Year III created a bicameral legislature and a five-member executive. The legislature consisted of the Council of Five Hundred (which proposed legislation) and the Council of Ancients (which approved or rejected laws). The executive was a five-member Directory. Deputies to the councils were chosen by an indirect electoral system with property qualifications for electors, while the Directory was chosen through the legislature's procedure (the Council of Five Hundred nominated candidates and the Council of Ancients appointed the five directors).

Rubric — Correct identification of two institutional features and accurate description of how deputies and directors were chosen.

Full marks (3 marks): Names both institutions (bicameral legislature: Council of Five Hundred and Council of Ancients; five-member Directory) AND correctly describes both selection methods: deputies chosen by indirect election with property qualifications, and the Directory chosen via the legislature (Five Hundred nominated candidates and the Ancients appointed the five directors).

Partial credit (1 marks): Names one institution correctly and gives a correct description of one of the selection methods, or names both institutions but gives only a partially correct or vague account of how deputies or directors were chosen (e.g. says 'elections' without mentioning indirect voting or property qualifications, or says 'chosen by the legislature' without specifying nomination/appointment roles).

No credit (0 marks): Fails to identify the required institutions or gives incorrect descriptions of how deputies and directors were chosen (e.g. claims universal male suffrage for deputies or that directors were elected directly by popular vote).

Q18.

Answer: The Directory faced intertwined political and economic problems that weakened civilian rule and encouraged military intervention. Economically, the government inherited chronic financial instability: the assignat had collapsed, public finances were broken, inflation and food shortages persisted, and the state relied on unpopular taxation and forced loans; these conditions fuelled urban unrest and discontent among peasants and workers. Politically, the Directory was divided and fragile: the bicameral system produced deadlock between Directors and the councils, royalists and Jacobins repeatedly tried to overturn the regime, and widespread corruption undermined its legitimacy. Faced with strikes, riots and conspiracies (for example the royalist attempt in the 13 Vendémiaire and the Jacobin resurgence), the Directory repeatedly turned to the army to restore order—using generals like Bonaparte and allowing military influence over politics. It also used military-backed purges (the coup of 18 Fructidor in 1797) to remove political opponents. These patterns show that economic hardship created social unrest and political fragmentation, and that the Directory's inability to resolve crises through institutions made it dependent on military force until Napoleon's coup on 18 Brumaire (9 November 1799) ended the regime.

Rubric — Explanation of political and economic challenges and the causal link to military reliance up to 18 Brumaire.

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly identifies both major economic problems (e.g. collapse of the assignat, inflation, food shortages, broken public finances) and political weaknesses (e.g. factional deadlock, royalist and Jacobin threats, corruption). Gives specific examples of military interventions (e.g. 13 Vendémiaire, 18 Fructidor, use of Bonaparte) and explains how economic distress and political fragmentation caused the Directory to rely on the army, leading up to 18 Brumaire. Response is focused and well supported by evidence.

Partial (3 marks): Mention of either economic problems or political weaknesses with at least one specific example, and a basic statement that the Directory used the army to deal with unrest. May lack clear causal explanation linking economic distress and political deadlock to military reliance, or gives only one or two examples without context.

Insufficient (0 marks): Provides minimal or vague statements (e.g. 'there were problems and the army helped') without specific examples or explanation of how economic and political issues produced dependence on military force. Misses dates, events, or causal links.

Q19.

Answer: From 1792 the Revolutionary government introduced large-scale national mobilisation through conscription and volunteer levies to create mass citizen armies (for example, the levée en masse of 1793 which drafted large numbers of men for the French armies). This mobilisation enabled French victories and expansion: by 1795 France had effectively annexed the Austrian Netherlands (after victories such as Jemappes in 1792 and subsequent occupation) and brought the Dutch Republic under French influence, creating the Batavian Republic in 1795. (Answer cites levée en masse 1793; Austrian Netherlands and Batavian Republic, by 1795.)

Rubric — Shows understanding of Revolutionary mobilisation and identifies two territorial gains with dates.

Full marks (3 marks): Clearly explains mobilisation (mentions conscription/levée en masse or large-scale volunteer mobilisation dated around 1793) and correctly names two territorial gains (Austrian Netherlands and Batavian Republic) with dates or year-by-1795; answer is concise and factually accurate.

Partial credit (2 marks): Identifies mobilisation (conscription or mass armies) but gives only one clear territorial gain with a correct date, or names two territories but omits dates or gives an unclear date reference.

Minimal credit (1 marks): Mentions either mobilisation OR one territorial gain with no date or only vague

references (e.g. 'they expanded' without naming territories), showing limited understanding.

Q20.

Answer: On 4 February 1794 the National Convention formally voted to abolish slavery in France's colonies and to grant full civic rights to colonial residents regardless of colour. Legally, this transformed slavery from an accepted social and economic institution into something banned by metropolitan law, at least on paper, and extended republican citizenship to freed people. The vote was connected to events in Saint-Domingue where revolutionary commissioners (sent to restore order) had already begun emancipating enslaved people earlier in response to rebellion, military necessity, and appeals to revolutionary ideals; their actions both anticipated and pressured the Convention to act. Motives for the Convention's decision combined ideology (*liberté, égalité*), military and political pragmatism (using freed people as allies against foreign and royalist forces), and reports from commissioners showing that emancipation could stabilise certain areas. A key consequence was that colonies experienced immediate social and political upheaval: in places like Saint-Domingue it strengthened emancipated leaders and helped turn a slave revolt into a wider anti-colonial conflict, while elsewhere the decree was resisted by colonists and unevenly implemented, revealing tensions between law in Paris and power on the ground.

Rubric — Explanation of legal change, link to commissioners in Saint-Domingue, motives/pressures, and a consequence for the colonies.

Level 1 — 6 marks (6 marks): States that the Convention voted to abolish slavery on 4 February 1794 and that commissioners in Saint-Domingue had begun emancipations; explains that the vote granted full civic rights regardless of colour; analyses motives (revolutionary ideology plus military/political pragmatism) and connects these to the commissioners' earlier actions; gives at least one clear consequence (e.g. strengthened emancipated leadership in Saint-Domingue, increased colonial upheaval, or uneven implementation and resistance).

Level 2 — 3–4 marks (4 marks): Identifies the 4 February 1794 abolition and mentions commissioners in Saint-Domingue; describes either the legal change (abolition and rights) or the link to the commissioners and motives, but offers only limited analysis of consequences or of how motives and events related to one another.

Level 3 — 0–2 marks (2 marks): Gives a vague or incomplete account (e.g. simply says 'slavery ended in 1794' or only mentions revolts) without connecting the decree to the commissioners, the motives behind the decision, or concrete consequences in the colonies; may contain significant inaccuracies.

Q21.

Answer: The guillotine became the principal symbol of the Terror because it combined a practical purpose with powerful public visibility and political meanings. Invented and promoted in the 1780s–1790s as a supposedly quick, humane, and equal method of execution, its design answered Enlightenment concerns about cruelty and standardised capital punishment for all social ranks. However, during the Terror (1793–1794) its frequent use made it a central feature of public life: mass executions at sites like the Place de la Révolution were public spectacles attended by thousands, which circulated images, songs, and stories that embedded the machine in popular culture. As a result, the guillotine came to symbolise revolutionary justice for some — an instrument of equality and the people's sovereignty — while for others it symbolised state violence and the Terror's excesses. Historians offer competing interpretations: some stress its role as a rational, Enlightenment reform (emphasising its intended humanity and legal equality), whereas others emphasise its role in political terror and social control (pointing to the

sheer scale of executions and the atmosphere of fear). A balanced answer recognises both uses: it was a technological and legal reform that, through public performance and partisan propaganda, became the iconic image of the Terror's capacity for both egalitarian justice and ruthless repression.

Rubric — Explains origins, public role, cultural meanings, and acknowledges competing interpretations.

Detailed and balanced (6 marks) (6 marks): Clearly explains the guillotine's invention as a quicker, supposedly more humane and egalitarian method; describes how frequent public executions and popular culture made it a visible symbol; gives at least one competing interpretation (e.g. humane reform vs. instrument of terror) and supports claims with specific examples or contexts (e.g. Place de la Révolution, songs/prints, scale of executions).

Partial explanation (3 marks) (3 marks): Explains either the invention/purpose or the public/cultural role but not both fully; mentions that the guillotine was symbolic of the Terror or of reform but gives limited evidence or does not present competing interpretations clearly.

Minimal or incorrect (0 marks) (0 marks): Provides a vague, inaccurate, or very short answer that fails to explain origins, public spectacle, or cultural meaning, and does not acknowledge alternative interpretations (for example, claims it was only a symbol of cruelty without nuance).

Q22.

Answer: Early in the Revolution women played visible and active political roles: they took part in demonstrations (for example the March on Versailles, 1789), produced and circulated political pamphlets, joined mixed political societies, and formed women's clubs and charities to press for economic relief and political reform. Organized groups such as the Society of Revolutionary Republican Women (founded 1793) show that women attempted sustained collective political action. Despite this activity, by the time of the constitutions of 1791 and 1793 women were denied formal political rights (they were not granted the vote or eligibility for most offices). The repression intensified in October 1793 when the National Convention banned women's clubs and societies, closing many women's organisations and excluding women from organised politics. Historians offer competing interpretations of this shift: some stress ideological and institutional reasons — revolutionary leaders who prioritized political unity and feared factionalism saw women's political activity as destabilising; others emphasise social and cultural factors, arguing that prevailing gender attitudes and fears about women's 'impropriety' in public life pushed leaders to reassert male political control. A further interpretation links the repression to wartime radicalisation and the rise of the Terror, when authorities suppressed groups seen as a threat to revolutionary order. Together these developments show an initial expansion of women's visible political roles followed by legal and practical exclusion by 1793.

Rubric — Explanation of change in women's political role and clear examples plus consideration of interpretations

Excellent (6 marks): Clearly explains both the early political activities of women (specific examples such as March on Versailles, pamphlets, women's clubs, Society of Revolutionary Republican Women) and the later repression (1791/1793 denial of political rights, October 1793 ban on women's clubs). Includes at least one plausible interpretation of why the change occurred (ideological/institutional, cultural/gender attitudes, or impact of wartime/Terror). Response is coherent and directly addresses the transition.

Satisfactory (3 marks): Describes either early female political activity or later repression with some specific detail and mentions the other in less detail (for example notes denial of rights or ban on clubs but without specific dates or examples). Offers a brief or general interpretation for the change (e.g. 'fear of instability' or 'gender prejudice') but lacks depth or clear linkage to examples.

Limited (0 marks): Gives minimal or inaccurate information: may assert that women were active or that they were repressed but provides little or no supporting examples, fails to explain the change, or repeats the misconception that women had equal political rights throughout the Revolution. No meaningful interpretation is offered.

Q23.

Answer: After 1789 the revolutionary government nationalised Church and émigré lands and issued assignats as paper money backed by those properties. Initially the assignats were a fiscal tool linked to land value, but the government issued them in ever larger quantities to finance spending. That excessive issuance—combined with poor harvests that reduced real goods available—caused the value of assignats to fall and prices to rise (inflation). In response, the government imposed price controls to limit rising food and commodity prices, but these controls created shortages and encouraged black markets because sellers refused to trade at fixed low prices. Historians debate emphasis: some stress over-issuance as the decisive cause of hyperinflation, others underline crop failures and wartime disruption that increased demand for currency relative to goods. The combined result was runaway inflation and economic distress, so by 1796 assignats had lost most of their value and were withdrawn and replaced to stabilise the currency.

Rubric — Explanatory understanding of how assignats, price controls and economic factors caused inflation and led to withdrawal in 1796

Full (6 marks) (6 marks): Explains clearly and accurately that Church and émigré lands were nationalised to back assignats; shows how excessive issuance plus poor harvests reduced real money value and caused inflation; describes how price controls led to shortages and black markets; notes the debate between causes (over-issuance vs. crop failures/war) and states that assignats were withdrawn in 1796 because they had lost value and destabilised the economy. Includes specific causal links and consequences.

Partial (3 marks) (3 marks): Identifies that assignats were backed by nationalised lands and that inflation resulted, and mentions either excessive issuance or poor harvests as a cause; recognises that price controls caused market problems or black markets; may lack clear causal links, detail, or the 1796 withdrawal explanation.

Minimal/Incorrect (0 marks) (0 marks): Gives only vague statements or factual errors (for example, denies nationalisation backing assignats or misstates the role of price controls) and does not explain the connections between issuance, shortages, inflation, and the 1796 withdrawal.

Q24.

Answer: The French Revolution had several long-term impacts. First, it ended feudal privileges in France and established legal equality before the law for men: aristocratic tax exemptions and seigneurial dues were abolished and these changes were enshrined in revolutionary legislation and later in the Napoleonic legal codes that spread across Europe. Second, it promoted individual freedoms and civic rights — ideas such as popular sovereignty, civil equality, and (increasingly) rights for citizens influenced later constitutions and reform movements across Europe. Third, the Revolution stimulated modern nationalism: the levée en masse and mass politics helped transform loyalty from dynastic rulers to the nation, a model imitated in other countries. Fourth, the Revolution exported institutional reforms — through Napoleonic conquest and reform — including uniform codes of law, secular administration, and merit-based civil service, which altered legal and administrative systems in many states. Historians debate the relative importance of these effects: some argue, for example, that liberal legal reforms (like

the Napoleonic Code) were the Revolution's most lasting achievement because they changed everyday rights and institutions across Europe; others counter that nationalism was more decisive in the long run because it reshaped state formation and 19th-century politics, sometimes even producing reactionary or authoritarian regimes. Taken together, these impacts show both concrete institutional change (laws, administrations) and broader shifts in political culture (rights and national identity), although the extent and timing of spread varied by country.

Rubric — Explanation and evaluation of multiple long-term impacts, with an example of historiographical disagreement.

Excellent (6 marks): Identifies at least three distinct long-term impacts (e.g. end of feudalism/legal equality, individual freedoms, nationalism, Napoleonic legal/administrative reforms) and explains how each affected France and Europe; provides a clear example of historians' disagreement about the importance of one effect and links this to evidence (e.g. Napoleonic Code vs. nationalism). Answer is coherent and cites specific mechanisms or examples of spread.

Partial (3 marks): Identifies two long-term impacts and explains them reasonably (for example legal change and nationalism or rights and administrative reforms), and mentions a historiographical disagreement in general terms but without clear linkage to evidence or without fully explaining its significance.

Insufficient (0 marks): Gives one or no clear long-term impacts or offers only vague statements (e.g. 'it changed Europe') with no concrete examples; no historiographical disagreement or only a superficial claim.